

Seagate Momentus XT

Seagate continues efforts with their hybrid hard drives which come with 4GB onboard flash memory along with the standard disk

BFG exits graphics market

BFG has decided to stop making graphics cards after failing to hit targets

Cellphone test

quite an unseemly bulge in ones pocket as well. The trackball is decent, but pales in comparison to the new trackpads. Another thing we noticed is the new Bold 9700 is slightly faster – this is especially noticeable in the multimedia folder, when the Bold 9000 takes noticeably longer to display thumbnails and previews of content. This is also visible in the menu structure, when selecting certain sub options, the newcomer is slightly faster in virtually all aspects.

Even the menu button is a bit larger and wider, ditto the call buttons. At first glance the display looks pretty sharp, but when you compare it to the new Bold 9700, one can make out a difference in sharpness, for the newcomer has a marginally higher resolution and a slightly smaller display.

Call quality and in-call clarity of the earpiece is good – we had no disconnected calls, and no issue with signal reception. The loudspeaker plays spoilsport – it distorts, and makes a mockery out of vocals when listening to music, especially at high volume levels. It is loud however, a small saving grace, the Bold 9700 offers slightly better audio quality.

Verdict

The Bold 9000, like the Curve 8900 is significantly



cheaper than it was last year, but we wonder if that alone will be enough to warrant recommendation. Its size is a deterrent, but those who get hooked to the large QWERTY keypad will probably not mind.

BlackBerry Bold 9700

Where the BlackBerry Bold 9000 was really wide to accommodate a slightly bigger keypad, the Bold 9700 goes slim, probably based on feedback from users who found the Bold 9000 too large. The leather now extends to nearly the entire battery cover and imparts a quality, upmarket feel. The “Bold” moniker embossed in the plastic on the rear above the battery cover looks a little tacky though. The chrome trim still runs around the sides and the bottom though

now it's only visible on the bottom of the device, it doesn't intrude on the very slim bezel – clearly screen area was of utmost importance, and the Bold 9700 marginally narrower than the Curve 8900. Although the device is well built, we noticed the battery cover developing slight play after just ten SIM card removals.

The trackpad on the 9700 is very sensitive, and works well. It's better than the trackball, and can be said to be an improvement. The voice command key, volume rocker button and camera button that are on the sides have a nice rubberised finish and aren't chromed, giving the 9700 a subtly classy look. The display has nice, sharp fonts – even fine print is very readable, and dark text is rendered on a white background beautifully.

Call clarity is good – the Bold 9700 has a slightly better loudspeaker than the Curve 8900 – calls are clearer, and even music sounds better. Thanks to the good earspeaker and antenna, calls are very clear and rarely is a call dropped – we encountered no breaks in call clarity during our tests. The camera is basic – decent colours but basic clarity. Camera settings are basic too.

Verdict

For those who just have to have a good BlackBerry handset – the Bold 9700 offers a quality handset with a very nice keypad and loads of features. It's stylish too – definitely for the upward business class; it doesn't come cheap though – Rs. 29,990 is a fair bit for a phone, especially with the



BlackBerry Bold 9700

craze of large, high resolution screens that is going around, the Bold 9700 isn't too hot for non-business class consumers.

BlackBerry Tour 9630

A solidly built device and one that features a sturdily constructed battery cover – solid plastic has been used. It's noticeably bigger than the Curve 8900 and Bold 9700, but smaller than the mighty

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